

CloudYuga debuts with a MOOC on containers

As containers are becoming the next big thing in the world of application development, Indian open source enthusiast, Neependra Khare, has launched his training and consulting startup, CloudYuga, to make things easier for Indian students and professionals.

CloudYuga offers training and consultation on various container solutions such as Docker, Rkt and Kubernetes. The first massive open online course (MOOC) that comes from CloudYuga is called 'Container Fundamentals', and it aims to



give participants a foundation in container technologies by covering their history as well as building blocks and runtimes.

"The idea behind Container Fundamentals is to build a MOOC platform for container technology, where one can learn everything about containers," said Khare, who was a principal software

engineer at Red Hat before establishing CloudYuga. The course delivers a hands-on experience to participants, since CloudYuga's partnership with DigitalOcean enables it to offer on-demand labs for each participant.

Instead of choosing an existing MOOC provider like Udemy, CloudYuga has built its own course platform. "We wanted to have complete control over our training material and student records. The course material will receive regular updates, and we will be interacting with students directly to get feedback and to share information," Khare said.

Those interested do not need to have any prior knowledge about containers to join the MOOC. Basic Linux experience is fair enough. Khare revealed that even with just one MOOC being offered initially, CloudYuga has received a good amount of registrations and community members are supporting the platform.

"Kudos to CloudYuga School for bringing a self-paced learning platform for container enthusiasts to keep abreast of the latest changes in the container space," wrote Docker captain Ajeet S. Raina in a testimonial on the CloudYuga website.

CloudYuga charges US\$99 for the complete course, which includes video sessions and text tutorials. *Open Source For You* readers can use the code 'CYOSFU40' and get a 40 per cent discount on each sign-up.

TensorFlow brings self-driving to Mario Kart

While many automotive companies are striving to impress customers with their self-driving concepts, the open source software library for machine intelligence, TensorFlow, is bringing the advanced driving model even to video games like Mario Kart.

Open source developer, Kevin Hughes, has deployed Google's TensorFlow to build a self-driving Mario Kart model, which he has called TensorKart. The developer has used the open source N64 emulator mupen64plus to play Mario Kart on his desktop computer, and has taken development support from TensorFlow and cuDNN. Also, he has written a Python program using open source libraries such as wxPython, Pygame and Matplotlib to continuously capture screenshots from the emulator, synchronised with a joystick input. This is the basis of the training set.

"The idea of exploring AI techniques in video games is not new, but what motivated me to do this project was to showcase the complete pipeline of a

Google Earth Enterprise to become open source in March

Google has announced that it is open sourcing its Earth Enterprise software in March 2017. With this development, organisations will be able to deploy Google Maps and the 3D view of Google Earth on their on-premise data centre infrastructure.

Originally introduced in 2006, Google Earth Enterprise (GEE) was being sold by the search giant till 2015. It was designed to let enterprise customers build and host their private, on-premise versions of Google Earth and Maps. But now, Google has given a two-year maintenance period to the customers to help them transition.

After the transition, Google's team is set to release the source code of the Earth Enterprise suite on GitHub under an Apache 2 licence. The open source package will include GEE Fusion, GEE Server and GEE Portable Server. "Open sourcing GEE allows our customer community to continue to improve and evolve the project in perpetuity," Avnish Bhatnagar, senior technical solutions engineer, Google Cloud, wrote in a blog post.

Google Cloud is used to host Earth images. The company will release instructions on using the Google Cloud Storage service with Google Earth before the source code becomes freely available in March 2017. Though a major part of the GEE suite will be open sourced, Google does not have plans to release the code for Google Earth Enterprise Client, Google Maps JavaScript API v3 and Google Earth API.

The imagery and terrain quadtree implementations used in the enterprise products will help third-party developers build viewers that can consume GEE Server Databases. This will enable Google to expand its presence among developers and enterprises.

Open sourcing server software will affect software providers in the same space, such as Esri or ArcGIS Server. But developers would ultimately get a chance to switch to Google's solutions for providing their custom maps and 3D globes.